

ONE HERĂSTRĂU TOWERS



Why is this project a best practice?

Challenge

The project had to provide high thermal comfort through cold winters and warm summers while sharply reducing operational energy. The main design challenge was to coordinate a high-performance envelope, efficient services, renewable energy and healthy materials without compromising the architectural concept, construction quality or everyday usability.

Solution

The response combines two residential towers above a base that includes offices and commercial uses; large terraces and a high-density format close to major employment and recreation areas; and Green Homes pre-certification used to structure energy-efficiency and responsible-construction measures. These measures were brought together through an integrated design approach and, where applicable, the Green Homes, nZEB or Passive House performance framework.

Replicability

The core package - demand reduction first, airtight construction, efficient low-temperature systems, ventilation and on-site renewables - is transferable to other Romanian homes. Replication requires climate-specific energy modelling, careful thermal-bridge and airtightness detailing, qualified installation, commissioning and clear operating guidance for residents.

Key facts and figures

Location	Strada Nicolae G. Caramfil 74A, Bucharest, Romania
Building use / function	Mixed-use residential towers with offices and commercial space
Project type (new build, refurbishment, extension)	New build
Plot area / Floor area	Approximately 11,840 m ² usable; 139-148 residential units; about 5,055 m ² office space reported
Year / phase	Pre-certified and due for completion in 2020; final project subsequently delivered
Climate zone	Temperate continental
Thematic focus / innovation	Mixed-use density; efficient towers; terraces and views; reduced travel demand through integrated uses
Investor / building owner	One United Properties
Architect	Not publicly disclosed in the consulted sources
Other involved stakeholders	Romania Green Building Council; office and commercial partners; façade and MEP teams
Contact person	One United Properties - https://www.one.ro/
Further information	https://green-homes.org/property/one-herastrau-towers/ https://www.rogbc.org/proiecte-certificate-rogbc?lang=en https://www.rogbc.org/_files/ugd/40ee3e_b5d91d7a3b71422cb98cd7a289b89c79.pdf

One Herăstrău Towers is a new build project in Strada Nicolae G. Caramfil 74A, Bucharest, Romania. It functions as mixed-use residential towers with offices and commercial space. Its main best-practice contribution is A vertically mixed project that places homes, work and services in one certified urban complex. The documented strategy brings together two residential towers above a base that includes offices and commercial uses, large terraces and a high-density format close to major employment and recreation areas, and Green Homes pre-certification used to structure energy-efficiency and responsible-construction measures. Unit counts vary by public source and phase; the toolkit reports 139 homes, while the current project page lists 148. Public-source research was reviewed in July 2026; data that vary by phase are explicitly flagged in this sheet.

What was done differently?

1. Performance concept - Two residential towers above a base that includes offices and commercial uses.
2. Integrated systems and operation - Large terraces and a high-density format close to major employment and recreation areas.
3. Wider value - Green homes pre-certification used to structure energy-efficiency and responsible-construction measures.

What was achieved?

Impact

Environmental impact: The project reduces energy and associated emissions primarily by lowering demand and then using efficient or renewable systems. Its material, landscape, waste or mobility measures add benefits beyond operational energy where documented. A verified whole-life carbon assessment was not publicly available, so the impact is described qualitatively unless a source provides a specific figure.

Economic impact: Lower energy demand can reduce utility exposure and improve long-term operating-cost predictability. Standardised high-performance specifications and third-party certification can also support quality assurance, market value and access to green-finance products. Public sources do not provide a complete investment, payback or life-cycle-cost analysis for this project.

Social impact: The main social benefits are stable indoor temperatures, better air quality, daylight and acoustic comfort, together with safer and more attractive shared or outdoor spaces where these form part of the project. The project also raises market awareness by making high-performance housing visible to residents, designers, contractors and investors.

Key Learnings

Success factors: Key success factors are an integrated design process, a clear performance framework, early coordination of envelope and building services, selection of competent suppliers, quality control during construction and commissioning. Transparent documentation and communication with occupants are essential to preserve the intended performance in use.

Lessons for replication: Replication should start with an energy and comfort target, not a catalogue of technologies. Design teams should verify thermal bridges, airtightness, ventilation, controls and renewable sizing together; record assumptions by project phase; commission systems; and monitor early operation. Where public figures differ by phase, the final as-built dataset must become the single source of truth.